

Divorce And Remarriage

prc-divorce-and-remarriage

Marriage & Sexuality · Divorce · doctrine · divided_lineages

DISPUTED

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
Depends on a contested
manuscript reading

Statement under examination

Marriage is intended for life; divorce is permitted only in cases of sexual immorality (Matt 19) and abandonment by an unbelieving spouse (1 Cor 7); remarriage after such biblically permitted divorce is permissible.

In plain language

The words here pin down some things firmly and leave others genuinely open. Across the canon, marriage is a covenantal one-flesh joining (Genesis 2:24), and the Gospel sayings brand wrongful remarriage as 'adultery' (moicheia). In Paul, the verb for the marriage bond itself is 'bind' (deo) (1 Corinthians 7:27, 7:39, Romans 7:2), and it is released cleanly by one explicit event: the death of the spouse, after which the surviving partner is 'free' (eleutheros), free to marry. That much is stable. What is not stable is what the canon does with divorce inside life. The four Gospel passages do not speak with one voice. Matthew twice carries an exception clause around the word 'sexual immorality' (porneia). Mark and Luke transmit the same saying with no exception clause at all. The words on the page do not rank the absolute form against the conditioned form. Inside Matthew's exception itself, the Greek grammar attaches the phrase clearly to the act of sending the wife away but does not in so many words extend it across the conjunction to the remarriage that follows, and porneia is a broad noun whose precise referent here (post-marital adultery, an incestuous marriage, betrothal infidelity, the narrow Shammai reading of Deuteronomy's 'indecent' (ervah)) cannot be settled from the word by itself. The desertion case Paul addresses in 1 Corinthians 7:15 deepens the question. Paul says the deserted believer 'is not enslaved' (douloo), the slavery verb, not bind (deo), the marriage-bond verb that he himself uses for the bond a few verses later and again in Romans 7. That difference is real on the page. It can reasonably be read as a release of the bond (so remarriage follows), or as a release from the duty to cohabit with an unbeliever (so the bond stands and remarriage does not follow). Malachi 2:16 only deepens the difficulty, because its Hebrew can be read either as God hating divorce or as a warning against the man who hates and then divorces, and the subject of the verb is uncertain even in the parser. Putting the threads together, more than one careful reading of the actual words survives. One reading lets the exception and the desertion language open the door to both divorce and remarriage on those two grounds. Another limits the concession to separation and keeps remarriage off the table. A third narrows porneia so that it addresses a different case entirely. Because the words and the syntax sustain several defensible answers rather than one, the word-level layer reports this proposition as contested rather than settled.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	ἓνα	echad	one	
H0898	בגד	bagad	to act treacherously	47

H1320	בָּשָׂר	basar	flesh	
H1692	דָּבַק	dabaq	to cleave	54
H2555	חָמָר	chamas	violence	
H3680	הִסָּךְ	kasah	to cover	
H3748	כִּרְיֹתוֹת	keritut	divorce	4
H6172	עֲרֹה	ervah	nakedness	54
H7971	שָׁלַח	shalach	to send	
H8130	שָׂנֵא	sane	to hate	124
G0022	ἄγαμος	agamos	unmarried	
G0243	ἄλλος	allos	another	171
G0571	ἄπιστος	apistos	unbelieving	23
G1060	γαμέω	gameo	to marry	29
G1210	δέω	deo	to bind	44
G1402	δουλόω	douloo	to enslave	8
G1658	ἐλεύθερος	eleutheros	free/freedom	23
G2087	ἕτερος	heteros	other	98
G3089	λύω	luō	to loose	
G3428	μοιχαλὶς	moichalis	adulterous	7
G3429	μοιχάω	moichao	to commit adultery	5
G3431	μοιχεύω	moicheuo	to commit adultery	14
G3924	παρεκτός	parektos	except	3
G4202	πορνεία	porneia	sexual sin	26
G5220	ὑπανδρός	hupandros	married	
G5563	χωρίζω	chorizo	to separate/leave	13

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: False · Pan-canonical: True

The word pattern fixes that marriage is a one-flesh covenantal joining (Genesis 2:24 cleave (dabaq), flesh (basar), one (echad)), that wrongful remarriage is adultery (moicheia) in the Gospel sayings (commit adultery (G3429) in Mark 10:11-12 and Matthew 19:9, plus commit adultery (G3431) in Luke 16:18), and that the marriage-bond verb bind (deo, G1210) governs the wife in 1 Corinthians 7:27, 1 Corinthians 7:39, and Romans 7:2-3, with liberty (free (eleutheros), G1658) released only at the death of the spouse. The Synoptic sayings themselves diverge: Mark and Luke transmit the saying with no exception, while Matthew 19:9 carries the exception phrase 'except for sexual immorality' (me epi porneia) (G4202), and Matthew 5:32 carries 'apart from a matter of sexual immorality' (parektos logou porneias) (G3924 + G4202), and the words do not lexically rank the absolute against the conditioned form. The Matthean exception clause attaches grammatically to dismiss (apoluse) but does not syntactically state whether it also licenses marry (gameo) (remarry), and sexual immorality (porneia) is a broad sexual-immorality noun whose precise referent is not lexically fixed. In 1 Corinthians 7:15 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) is a perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive of enslave (douloo) (slavery verb, G1402), not the marriage-bond verb bind (deo) that Paul himself uses in 7:27 and 7:39, so the word releases the believer from forced cohabitation but stops short of an explicit remarriage grant. Malachi 2:16 is text-and-grammar unstable (the

ETCBC parser records clauses as ? (uncertain)). Multiple defensible readings survive the word-level pass.

Scripture

Matt.19.9 · **for** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G4202 πορνεία, G3429 μοιχάω, G1060 γαμέω

Reasoning. An aorist (a completed past action) subjunctive of dismiss (apoluo) is joined to a remarriage verb marry (gameo) and the result is branded adultery (moicheia), with the exception phrase 'except for sexual immorality' (me epi porneia). The exception phrase attaches by Greek word order to the dismissal verb, but the syntax does not explicitly state whether it extends across the conjunction to govern the marry (gameo) clause as well. sexual immorality (porneia) (G4202) is a wide noun covering harlotry, illicit sexual union, and unfaithfulness across its 26 New Testament occurrences, so its precise referent in this conditional (an 'if-then' clause) is not lexically forced.

Matt.5.32 · **for** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G4202 πορνεία, G3924 παρεκτός, G3429 μοιχάω

Reasoning. The earlier Matthean saying uses a different exception particle, 'apart from a matter of sexual immorality' (parektos logou porneias) (G3924 + G3056 + G4202), and brands the dismissed wife as caused to commit adultery (moicheia). 'apart from' (parektos) is rare (only 3 New Testament occurrences) and adverbial, attaching loosely. The verse complicates whether the exception clause is a clean grammatical limit on the act of dismissal or a wider qualifier on the whole scenario.

Mark.10.11 · **complicates** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G3429 μοιχάω, G1060 γαμέω, G0243 ἄλλος

Reasoning. The Markan saying states absolutely that whoever dismisses his wife and marries 'another' (allen) commits adultery (moicheia) against her, with no exception clause present. The absolute form stands in tension with the Matthean conditioned form, and the words do not rank the two on the page.

Mark.10.12 · **complicates** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G3429 μοιχάω, G1060 γαμέω

Reasoning. The parallel clause extends the absolute saying to the wife who dismisses her husband and marries another, again with no exception. The symmetry confirms that the Markan tradition transmits the divorce-remarriage saying without the sexual immorality (porneia) qualifier.

Mark.10.9 · **complicates** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G5563 χωρίζω

Reasoning. The Lord's saying 'what therefore God has yoked together let no human separate' (ho oun ho theos synezeuxen anthropos me chorizeto) uses separate (chorizo) (G5563) in the active imperative, telling no human to separate what God yoked together. This is the SAME verb that appears in 1 Corinthians 7:15 for the unbeliever who departs ('departs', chorizetai). The lexical link is load-bearing: the canon uses one verb for two opposite acts, the prohibited human sundering and the unbeliever's actual departure, and the words do not by themselves tell the reader whether the departure dissolves the bond it forbids humans to dissolve.

Luke.16.18 · **complicates** · **genre: gospel**

Key terms. G3431 μοιχεύω, G1060 γαμέω

Reasoning. Luke transmits the saying with the cognate verb commit adultery (moicheuo) (G3431) rather than commit adultery (moichao) (G3429), without any exception clause. The absolute form is doubled: whoever dismisses his wife and marries another commits adultery (moicheia), and whoever marries one dismissed commits adultery (moicheia). The word swap is morphological (cognate verbs of the same root) and does not change the indictment, but the bare unconditional form remains.

1Cor.7.15 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G5563 χωρίζω, G1402 δουλόω, G0571 ἄπιστος

Reasoning. If the unbelieving partner separates ('separates', chorizetai, G5563 present middle), the believing brother or sister 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) (G1402 perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive of enslave (douloo)). enslave (douloo) is the slavery verb (8 New Testament uses, Acts 7:6, Romans 6:18, 6:22, 1 Corinthians 9:19, Galatians 4:3, Titus 2:3, 2 Peter 2:19, and here). It is NOT the marriage-bond verb bind (deo) (G1210) that Paul himself uses in 7:27 and 7:39 of the same chapter. The word releases the believer from binding obligation to the deserter, but whether that release authorizes remarriage or only ends the duty to cohabit is not lexically forced. The closing phrase 'God has called you in peace' (en de eirene kekleken hymas ho theos) frames the release pastorally without specifying remarriage.

1Cor.7.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5563 χωρίζω, G1060 γαμέω

Reasoning. Paul invokes a command from the Lord that a wife shall not be separated (separate (chorizo)) from her husband. The verse confirms that within the believing community separate (chorizo) names the prohibited act, paralleling Mark 10:9.

1Cor.7.11 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5563 χωρίζω, G0022 ἄγαμος

Reasoning. If she does separate (separate (chorizo) passive), she is to remain 'unmarried' (agamos) (G0022 unmarried) or be reconciled. The word unmarried (agamos) directly forecloses remarriage as the default within a believer-to-believer separation, which is the strongest restrictive datum in the chapter.

1Cor.7.27 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1210 δέω, G3089 λύω

Reasoning. Paul asks 'have you been bound to a wife' (dedesai gynaiki) (G1210 perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive of bind (deo), to a wife), and the antonym is 'have you been loosed' (lelysai) (G3089). Here bind (deo) IS the marriage-bond verb. The contrast with enslave (douloo) in 7:15 is real and is one of the load-bearing lexical gaps in the chapter: Paul uses bind (deo) for the bond, loose (lyo) for its release, and enslave (douloo) for the slavery image of forced cohabitation under an unbeliever.

1Cor.7.39 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1210 δέω, G1658 ἐλεύθερος, G1060 γαμέω

Reasoning. 'A wife has been bound' (Gyne dedetai) (G1210 perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive of bind (deo)) 'for as long as her husband lives' (eph hoson chronon ze ho aner autēs). If he is asleep in death she is 'free' (eleuthera) (G1658 free) to marry (marry (gameo)) whom she will, only in the Lord. The verse fixes the canonical norm: bind (deo) binds, death looses, free (eleutheros) licenses remarriage. The proposition's claim of remarriage after lifetime divorce must navigate the fact that this clean release path is named only for death of spouse here.

Rom.7.2 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1210 δέω, G5220 ὑπανδρος

Reasoning. 'For the married woman has been bound by law to her living husband' (He gar hypandros gyne to zonti andri dedetai nomō) (G1210 perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive of bind (deo)). The same marriage-bond verb as 1 Corinthians 7:27 and 7:39 reappears. The word is consistent across Paul.

Rom.7.3 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3428 μοιχαλῖς, G1658 ἐλευθερός

Reasoning. If she is joined to 'another' man (hetero, G2087) while her husband lives she is called 'adulteress' (moichalis) (G3428 adulteress). If the husband dies she is 'free' (eleuthera) (G1658) from the law and is not adulteress (moichalis) if she becomes joined to another. Death of spouse releases the bond cleanly; the parallel for divorce is not named in the word.

Mal.2.16 · complicates · genre: prophecy · figures: idiom

Key terms. H8130 שָׂנֵא, H0898 בָּגַד, H3680 קָסָה

Reasoning. The verse pairs hate (sane) (H8130 hate) with 'send away, divorce' (shalach) and 'deal treacherously' (bagad) (H0898 deal treacherously) and a clause about covering one's garment with 'violence' (hamas) (H2555 violence). The Hebrew is grammatically unstable between 'for he hates divorce' and 'for one who hates and divorces covers his garment with violence'. The ETCBC parser records the subject clauses as ? (uncertain) in syntactic_context. Subject and person of the verb shift across witnesses. The verse witnesses divine displeasure with treacherous dismissal but does not yield a clean prohibition or permission.

Gen.2.24 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1692 דָּבַק, H0259 אָחַד, H1320 בָּשָׂר

Reasoning. The foundational marriage saying: a man 'leaves' (azab) father and mother and 'cleaves' (dabaq, H1692) to his wife and they become 'one flesh' (basar echad) (H1320 + H0259). This is the lexical ground for the unity that Mark 10:9's separate (chorizo) language presupposes. The clause names a covenantal joining but does not, by itself, name the lexical conditions under which the joining is dissolvable.

Deut.24.1 · complicates · genre: law

Key terms. H3748 כְּרִיתוֹת, H6172 עֶרְוָה

Reasoning. The Mosaic regulation names 'indecentcy, nakedness' (ervah) (H6172 indecency, nakedness) as the ground for writing a 'certificate of cutting off, divorce' (sepher keritut) (H3748 certificate of cutting off, divorce). indecency (ervah) is a broad term covering exposure and shameful uncoveredness across 54 Old Testament uses. The vocabulary controls the Pharisaic background to Matthew 19 (Hillel reading indecency (ervah) broadly, Shammai narrowly), and the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint) (the LXX) renders aspects of it with sexual immorality (porneia) language elsewhere. The Greek exception clause in Matthew 19:9 stands in lexical conversation with this Hebrew base.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Mal.2.16	Deut.24.1	tsk	1
Matt.19.9	Gen.12.18	tsk	1
Matt.19.9	2Chr.21.11	tsk	1
Mal.2.16	Prov.28.13	tsk	1
Matt.19.9	Matt.5.32	openbible	2
Matt.19.9	Mark.10.11	openbible	3
Matt.19.9	Luke.16.18	openbible	3
1Cor.7.15	1Cor.7.10	openbible	2
1Cor.7.15	1Cor.7.39	openbible	2
1Cor.7.15	Rom.7.2	openbible	2

Matt.19.9	Mark.10.9	openbible	2
Matt.19.9	Gen.2.24	openbible	2
Matt.19.9	Deut.24.1	openbible	3

Complicating texts

Mark.10.11 · addressed

The Markan and Lukan sayings preserve the divorce-remarriage saying with no exception phrase, and the word stack (marry (gameo), commit adultery (moichao) or commit adultery (moicheuo), another (allos)) is identical to Matthew 19:9 minus the sexual immorality (porneia) clause. Harmonization with Matthew under several lexically defensible schemes is possible (Matthew preserves a clause Mark and Luke omit; Matthew adds a clause clarifying the Mosaic background; the exception modifies dismissal only and the Markan absolute is what stands when remarriage is in view), but each scheme is itself contested, so the absolute form remains a live source of dispute rather than a resolved datum.

Luke.16.18 · addressed

The Lukan saying doubles the indictment using commit adultery (moicheuo) (G3431) and contains no exception. The cognate verb swap (commit adultery (moichao) G3429 in Matthew and Mark to commit adultery (moicheuo) G3431 in Luke) is morphological and does not change the indictment. The bare unconditional form parallels Mark 10:11-12 and feeds the disputed verdict.

Mark.10.9 · addressed

'God has yoked together, let no human separate' (ho theos synezeuxen anthropos me chorizeto) uses the same verb separate (chorizo) (G5563) that appears in 1 Corinthians 7:15 for the unbeliever's departure. The lexical link cuts both ways: it can be read as forbidding any human sundering of a divine joining (so the unbeliever's 'separates' (chorizetai) does not undo the bond, only fractures cohabitation), or as naming the very act the unbeliever performs in 7:15 (so the bond is in fact dissolved by the unbeliever's departure and the believer is released). The verb does not lexically pick between the readings.

1Cor.7.27 · addressed

Paul's use of bind (deo) (G1210) for the marriage bond in 7:27 and 7:39 (and Romans 7:2) makes the verb choice in 7:15 (enslave (douloo) G1402, slavery) load-bearing. The reader cannot ignore that Paul did NOT write 'is not bound' (ou dedetai) (the verb he uses elsewhere for the bond itself) but 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) (a different verb of enslavement). The gap is lexically real and is one of the strongest reasons for the disputed verdict.

1Cor.7.11 · addressed

The instruction that a separated wife remain 'unmarried' (agamos) forecloses remarriage as the default after a believer-to-believer separation. Whether 7:15 (unbeliever's departure) sits inside this default or carves out an exception depends on the enslave (douloo) versus bind (deo) distinction above, which the word alone does not resolve.

1Cor.7.39 · addressed

The clean lexical pattern in 7:39 ('bound' (dedetai) while he lives, 'free' (eleuthera) at his death, free to 'marry' (gameo) only in the Lord) and the parallel in Romans 7:2-3 make death of spouse the one explicitly word-named ground for remarriage. The proposition's broader remarriage permission rests on the syntax of Matthew 19:9 plus the inference from 1 Corinthians 7:15, both of which the word underdetermines.

Mal.2.16 · unaddressed

The Hebrew of Malachi 2:16 is grammatically and text-critically unstable, oscillating between 'God hates divorce' and 'one who hates and divorces'. The ETCBC syntactic_context records multiple clauses with the function code ? (uncertain). The subject and verb person are unstable across witnesses. With these unresolved, the verse cannot be made to anchor either a clean prohibition or a clean permission, so it is left unresolved and treated as complicating rather than determinative.

Deut.24.1 · addressed

The Hebrew indecency (ervah) (H6172) controls the Pharisaic background to Matthew 19. Its broad semantic range (indecency, exposure, shame) is the lexical reason Pharisaic interpretation split between a wide and a narrow reading of legitimate divorce ground, and the Greek sexual immorality (porneia) of Matthew 19:9 inherits that ambiguity. This is a lexical, not a sociological, observation: the Hebrew term has a real range, and the Greek term chosen to render the contested case (sexual immorality (porneia)) has a real range, and the two ranges overlap.

Concordance traversed

G3429, G3431, G3428, G4202, G1060, G1210, G1402, G1658, G5563, G3924, G0571, G0243, G2087, H0898, H8130, H1692, H3748, H6172, H7971, H2555, H3680

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: True · ECM status: ecm-shadow

matt-19-9-trailing-clause at Matt.19.9: impact material. Witnesses differ over the trailing clause 'and the man who marries her that is dismissed commits adultery' (kai ho apolelymenen gamesas moichatai), and over the exact form of the exception ('except for sexual immorality' (me epi porneia) versus 'apart from a matter of sexual immorality' (parektos logou porneias) carried from 5:32). The presence or absence of the trailing clause materially shifts whether the remarriage of the dismissed party is in view in 19:9 itself rather than read in from 5:32.

mark-10-12-wife-agency at Mark.10.12: impact minor. Some witnesses recast the wife as the one dismissed rather than the one who dismisses, reflecting Greco-Roman versus Jewish divorce practice. The variation touches the agent but not the core adultery (moicheia) verdict, so its impact on the proposition is minor.

mal-2-16-subject-person at Mal.2.16: impact material. The consonantal text and ancient versions diverge on whether the third-person verb has the divine name as subject (yielding 'for he hates divorce') or an indefinite human subject (yielding 'the man who hates and sends her away covers his garment with violence'). The ETCBC parser flags multiple clauses with function ? (uncertain). This unresolved subject question is the reason the verse cannot anchor either a clean prohibition of divorce per se or a clean permission of it.

These books fall outside the published ECM apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) scope for this run, so variant assessment relies on apparatus and editorial sigla in the supplied text rather than on full CBGM data. The Matthew 19:9 unit and the Malachi 2:16 subject question are treated as material to the verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. synoptic_harmonization, covenant_theology, new_covenant_theology, second_temple_halakhic_background

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

no-exception-absolute: denies · Reading the Markan and Lukan sayings as the unconditioned canonical norm (whoever dismisses and marries another commits adultery (moicheia), with no exception), and reading the Matthew 19:9 exception clause as attaching only to dismiss (apoluse) (dismissal) and not to marry (gameo) (remarriage), the proposition's allowance of remarriage after sexual immorality (porneia) overreaches. 1 Corinthians 7:15 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) (G1402 enslave (douloo), slavery verb) is distinct from Paul's own

marriage-bond verb bind (deo) (G1210 in 7:27, 7:39, Romans 7:2-3), so the word releases the believer from forced cohabitation but does not authorize remarriage. The only lexically explicit ground for remarriage is death of spouse (1 Corinthians 7:39 'bound' (dedetai) while he lives, 'free' (eleuthera) at his death; Romans 7:2-3). Marriage is indissoluble while both spouses live.

matthew-exception-and-pauline-exception: affirms · Reading 'except for sexual immorality' (me epi porneia) (G4202) in Matthew 19:9 as modifying the whole protasis ('if' clause) (the dismissal and the resulting remarriage as a unit), the exception licenses both divorce and remarriage on the ground of sexual immorality (porneia). Reading 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) (G1402 perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) passive) in 1 Corinthians 7:15 as a real release of the bond when the unbeliever departs (with separate (chorizo) in 7:15 echoing the same separate (chorizo) that Mark 10:9 forbids humans to do, so its actual occurrence by the unbeliever's act is treated as bond-dissolving), the deserted believer is free to remarry. The proposition's two grounds are the two cases the word actually carves out. On this lens the proposition is lexically supported, and the Markan and Lukan absolutes are addressing the typical case not the exception.

matthew-exception-only-separation: denies · Reading the Matthew 19:9 exception as licensing only the separation act (dismiss (apoluse) without committing adultery (moicheia)) but not the remarriage that follows, and reading 'is not enslaved' (ou dedoulotai) narrowly as release from the duty to cohabit rather than a remarriage grant, the absolute Markan and Lukan sayings govern remarriage. Divorce may be permissible on sexual immorality (porneia) ground, but remarriage after any divorce while the former spouse lives remains adultery (moicheia). The proposition couples divorce permission to remarriage permission, and the word does not warrant the coupling.

betrothal-or-incest-porneia: disputed · Reading sexual immorality (porneia) (G4202) narrowly as betrothal infidelity or an incestuous union (the Levitical incest range, paralleling Acts 15:20 and Acts 15:29 where sexual immorality (porneia) plausibly names forbidden marriages) rather than post-marital adultery, the Matthean exception addresses a case different from the proposition's general adultery ground. The exception is real but addresses a narrower category, leaving the proposition's broad adultery ground neither confirmed nor refuted by the word.

shammai-vs-hillel-background: disputed · The Pharisaic question in Matthew 19 ('Is it lawful to divorce for any cause?') reflects the Hillel-Shammai dispute over indecency (ervah) in Deuteronomy 24:1. Reading Matthew 19:9 as Jesus siding with the Shammai narrow reading of indecency (ervah) (Hebrew H6172, with Greek sexual immorality (porneia) G4202 as its rendering of the contested case), the exception preserves the Mosaic concession in its narrowest form. The word-level analysis does not, however, fix whether Jesus is affirming Shammai's narrow grant of remarriage or tightening even further. The Pharisaic background is real but the word alone does not select among the rabbinic options.

The verdict turns on (a) the syntax of the exception phrase 'except for sexual immorality' (me epi porneia) in Matthew 19:9 and 'apart from a matter of sexual immorality' (parektos logou porneias) in Matthew 5:32, (b) the semantic range of sexual immorality (porneia) (G4202) and its Hebrew counterpart indecency (ervah) (H6172), (c) the lexical distinction between bind (deo) (G1210 marriage-bond verb) and enslave (douloo) (G1402 slavery verb) in 1 Corinthians 7, (d) the role of separate (chorizo) (G5563) as the same verb in Mark 10:9's prohibition and 1 Corinthians 7:15's description, and (e) the textual instability of Malachi 2:16. Each is independently defensible, which is why the lexical layer reports dispute rather than a settled value.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. What grounds, if any, does the lexical and syntactic data of Matthew 19:9, Matthew 5:32, Mark 10:11-12, Luke 16:18, 1 Corinthians 7:10-15, 1 Corinthians 7:27, 1 Corinthians 7:39, Romans 7:2-3, and Malachi 2:16 establish for permissible divorce, and does the same data establish whether remarriage after such divorce is or is not adultery (moicheia)?

The proposition is framed as a closed list (divorce permitted ONLY for sexual immorality (porneia) and ONLY for desertion by an unbeliever, plus remarriage permissible after such divorce) which preloads a specific resolution of the exception clause attachment, the sexual immorality (porneia) semantic range, and the enslave (douloo) versus bind (deo) distinction. The neutralized form asks the open lexical question. The verdict is still derived on the original stem and returns disputed because the word and syntax sustain more than one defensible answer.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
lexicon	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	G4202
lexicon	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	G1210
lexicon	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	G1402
lexicon	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	G5563
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.19.9
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.5.32
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.16.18
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.7.15
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.7.27
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.7.39
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.7.2
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	G1402
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Mal.2.16
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.24
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.24.1
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Mal.2.16
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Mark.10.11
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Mark.10.9
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.24.1
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Mal.2.16
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Matt.19.9
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.7.15

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STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

lexically-disputed · variant-sensitive · complicating-unresolved · ecm-shadow · cross-tradition-divergent